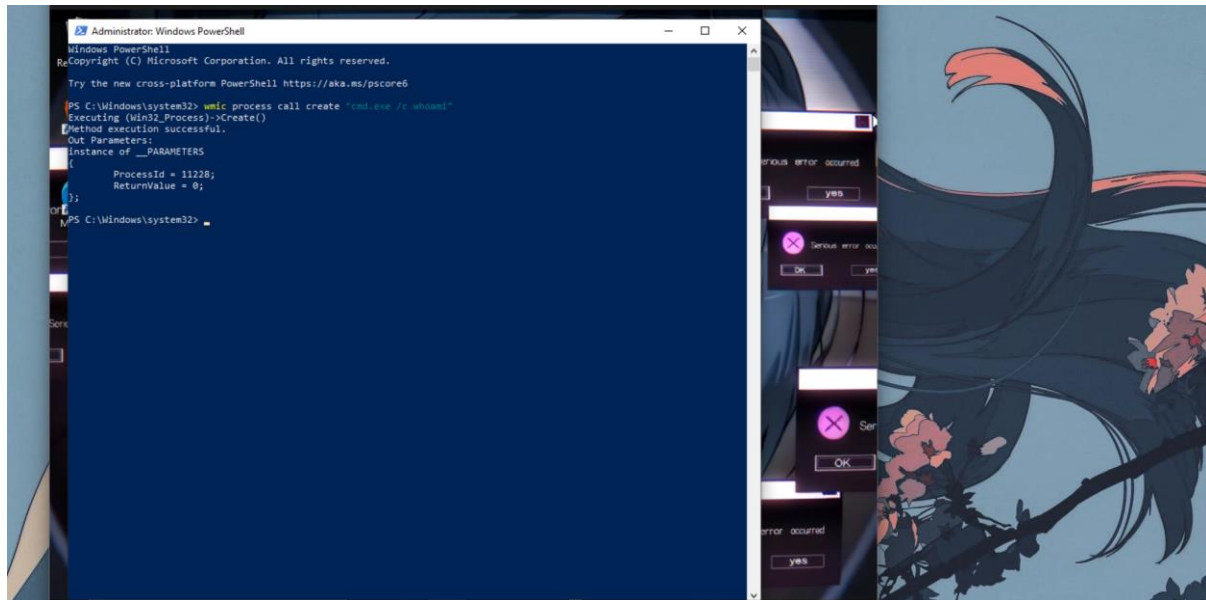


## Lateral Movement – WMIC Execution

The command was executed using WMIC to simulate remote or indirect command execution.

This technique allows execution through the WMI service, which can obscure the original source of the command.



In the SIEM, a sequence of events was observed, including WMIC, cmd.exe, and whoami.exe. This process chain indicates command execution via WMI, a known lateral movement technique.

A screenshot of a SIEM search results interface. The search query is: 

```
1 FROM logs*
2 | WHERE process.name IN ("WMIC.exe", "cmd.exe", "whoami.exe")
3 | KEEP @timestamp, process.command_line, process.hash.sha256, user.name, host.name
4 | SORT @timestamp DESC
```

The results table shows 7 results. A red box highlights a sequence of four events that form a process chain for lateral movement. The events are as follows:

| @timestamp                  | process.command_line                                                     | process.hash.sha256                                              | user.name | host.name |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Apr 19, 2026 @ 22:20:07.814 | "C:\Windows\system32\whoami.exe"                                         | 1d4902a04d99e8ccbfe7085e63155955fee397449d386453f6c452ae407b8743 | oolai     | asd       |
| Apr 19, 2026 @ 19:02:58.932 | whoami                                                                   | 1d4902a04d99e8ccbfe7085e63155955fee397449d386453f6c452ae407b8743 | oolai     | asd       |
| Apr 19, 2026 @ 19:02:58.660 | cmd.exe /c whoami                                                        | badf4752413cb0cbd03fb95828ca167f0cdc63b597ccdb5ef43111180e088b0  | oolai     | asd       |
| Apr 19, 2026 @ 19:02:58.424 | "C:\Windows\System32\Wbem\WMIC.exe" process call create "cmd.exe /c ..." | da603fa720ab43aa6d4d36aa9fdb828dab9645523eabaac209af6451d5b4d757 | oolai     | asd       |

The activity was classified as a True Positive due to its behavior and execution pattern.

The screenshot displays a web-based security dashboard interface. The browser's address bar shows the URL: `my-security-project-e5851b.kb.us-central1.gcp.elastic.cloud/app/security/cases/9c809ed6-4e35-4...`. The page title is "My Security project / Cases / Cases / Wmic.exe".

The main content area features a vertical timeline of events on the left, with a circular navigation menu on the far left. The events are as follows:

- Soc L2 added an event 35 minutes ago
- Soc L2 added 4 observables 35 minutes ago
- Soc L2 assigned themselves 7 minutes ago
- Soc L2 set severity to **Medium** 4 minutes ago
- Soc L2 added the category "Lateral movement" 3 minutes ago
- Soc L2 added a comment 21 seconds ago: "WMIC was used to create a process that executed a command (whoami). This may indicate suspicious activity related to lateral movement."
- Soc L2 added tags **lateral movement**, **wmic**, and **mitre\_T1047** 13 seconds ago

On the right side of the dashboard, there are several panels:

- Participants:** Lists "Soc L2".
- Tags:** Displays "lateral movement", "wmic", and "mitre\_T1047".
- Category:** Shows "Lateral movement".
- External incident management system:** Includes a button "Select an external connector" and a note: "To create and update a case in an external system, select a connector."

The interface has a dark theme and a sidebar with various tool icons on the left.